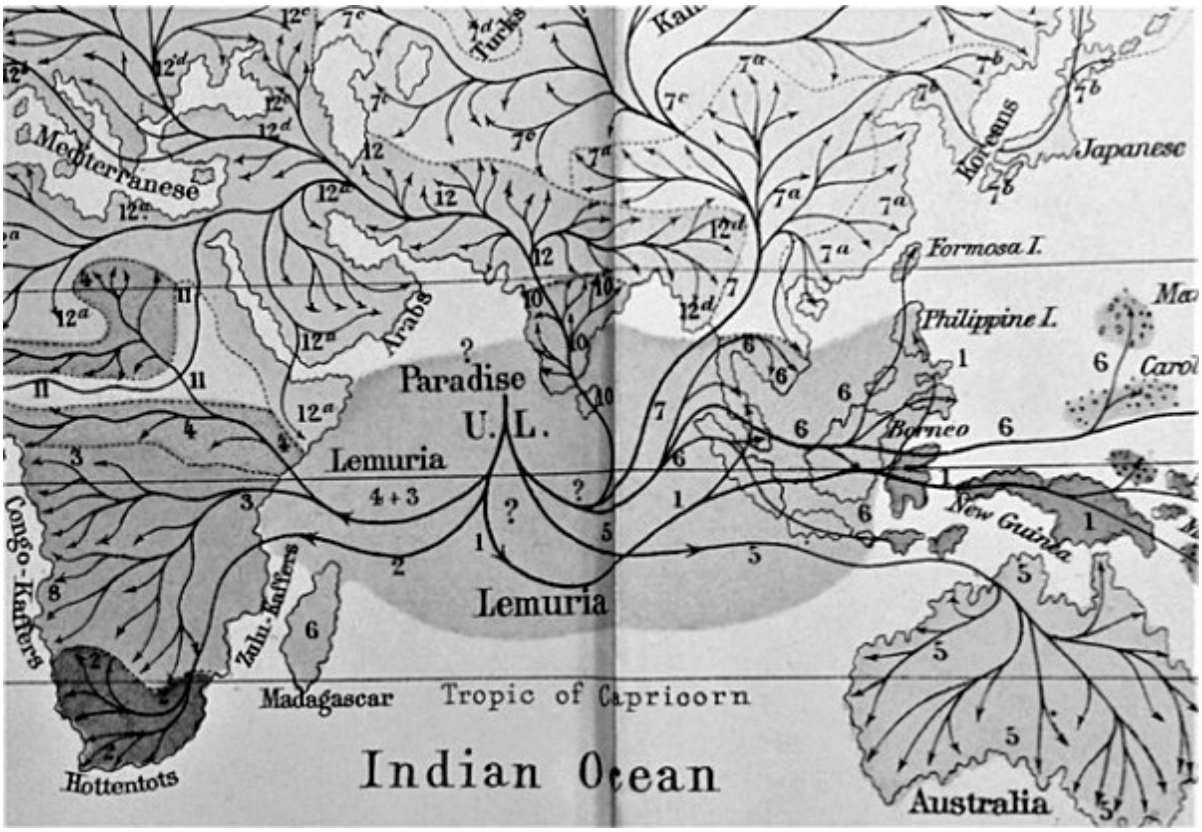
led him to propose that there must at one time have been a ‘great continent’ that had formed a land-bridge linking India to Africa, which he named Lemuria. Other zoologists as well as geographers picked up the idea, just as the concept of continental drift was becoming established, among them the German evolutionary biologist Ernst Haeckel, who proposed in his *History of Creation* that this Lemuria was the cradle of mankind, the original paradise from which humans had emerged to populate the Earth by way of India and Africa.[12]



Lemuria or Paradise as the cradle of mankind. Detail from Ernst Haeckel’s map ‘Hypothetical sketch of the monophyletic origin and of the extension of the 12 races of man from Lemuria over the earth’, as it appeared in English in 1876.

Haeckel’s theory first became known in India when it was mentioned in the three-volume *Manual of the Administration of the Madras Presidency*, an official government document